



Astra March Hiring 2026-2027 Resource Package



Introduction

Hiring Process

CREO Astra uses a two round interview process to evaluate and hire its Product Engineers (1st or 2nd year students).

The first round is a 20-minute interview broken down into two sections: behavioral questions and qualitative coding understanding questions. Some time is also left at the end for the candidate to ask the executive team any questions on their mind.

The second round involves a take home component and a 30 minute interview. The take home component is an Technical Competency Assessment (TCA): Candidates will be given a problem scenario and tasked with designing and building a prototype/demo that addresses the core user needs. The assessment must include a technical component demonstrating the candidate's ability to execute their idea.

The second round interview is broken down into three sections: behavioural questions, TCA presentation and an TCA question period by the interviewers. Some time is also left at the end for the candidate to ask the executive team any questions on their mind.

What We Look For

Problem Solving Ability

- Almost all of CREO's work involves problem solving. Members need to be able to logically understand, structure, and solve problems.

Creativity

- To deliver value to clients, CREO members often need to come up with unique ideas and to think outside of the box.

Initiative

- CREO's success as an organization is a result of all members taking initiative on a regular basis. Regardless of seniority on the club, all members are encouraged to contribute new ideas for internal and external club matters.

Character and Commitment

- Most critical to the success of CREO members is a great work ethic, an ability to lead and work with teams, and a willingness to accept and grow from feedback.

Behavioral Interview Questions

General Advice

We encourage you to use the behavioral section of the interview to demonstrate the qualities listed before such as hard work, leadership, collaboration, and initiative.

No behavioral questions will seek to confuse candidates or to “trip them up” and will all focus on the executive trying to learn more about the candidate through their prior experiences.

To best communicate your stories, feel free to use common interview response structures such as the STAR method. Provide context for the situation you were in, discuss what your task was, explain what actions you took, and finally talk about the results that came from your actions.

Make sure not to ramble or take too long with a response, as this will degrade your answer.

The questions to the right are examples of the types of questions CREO asks. They may or may not be asked in your interview.

Sample Questions

Tell Me About Yourself.

- Keep it short, no more than 1-2 minutes. Talk about 1-3 of your experiences or interests and very briefly touch on why you are interested in joining on CREO.

Tell Me About a Time You Solved a Problem in a Team.

- Talk about the team situation and task and focus on what you individually did within the team. Show that you can manage team dynamics.

Tell Me About a Time You Took Initiative.

- Discuss the situation at hand and what you did that was outside the scope of your assigned task. Explain why you decided to take initiative in that given situation.

Tell Me About a Time You Struggled to Overcome an Obstacle.

- Demonstrate your ability to persevere through a problem. Talk about what you were struggling with and what you did specifically to overcome the difficulty.

Qualitative Coding Understanding

General Advice

CREO Astra aims to understand candidates' interaction with technology through qualitative coding questions. This approach reveals the candidates' methods of processing technical information and solving technical problems, providing insight into their technological proficiency and problem-solving skills.

No qualitative coding questions will require candidates to write code. During this portion of the interview CREO Astra is working to understand your technical problem-solving skills, passion and motivation, and agility.

Similar to behavioural questions, to best communicate your stories, feel free to use common interview response structures such as the STAR method. Focusing on highlighting the "so-what"

The questions to the right are examples of the types of questions CREO asks. They may or may not be asked in your interview.

Sample Questions

Tell Me About a Time When You Had to Troubleshoot a Challenging Bug in Your Code.

- Describe at high-level the project you were working on and the step-by-step process you took to identify and solve the bug. Explain what you learned from this and any impact it has had on your technical knowledge.

Tell me about a technology trend or innovation excites you the most currently, and how have you explored or integrated it into your projects or learning?

- Discuss what this technology trend is and why it excites you. Explain how this trend influenced your technical knowledge.

Tell Me About a Time Someone Successfully Explained a New Technical Topic to You.

- Describe what made the explanation easy to understand and how this impacted the way you communicate technical information.

Technical Competency Assessment (TCA)

General Advice

The TCA allows candidates to display their technical knowledge, communication skills and ability to derive meaningful business insights from data and communicate them effectively.

Candidates will be sent the TCA instructions and have two days to complete it (March 7th to 8th). The TCA instructions will include a problem scenario requiring candidates to design and build a lightweight prototype or demo that addresses the core user need. Candidates are encouraged to use tools and technologies they are most comfortable with—solutions are evaluated equally based on thinking, execution, and clarity.

The TCA is not intended to confuse candidates or “trip them up,” but rather to help the executive team understand each candidate’s product thinking, technical approach, and ability to communicate their decisions clearly.

A member of the Astra hiring team will be available to answer any questions candidates may have about the TCA throughout the two-day working period.

Helpful Tips

Ensure to look over the problem scenario before deciding on a topic to explore.

- Ensuring you understand *all* aspects of the problem scenario leads to more in-depth insights.

Leave time for presentation planning.

- An easy-to-follow presentation allows Astra to better understand your thought process and insights. Ensure to highlight any next steps (if any) at the end of your presentation.

Don't be afraid to remove columns from the dataset if they don't have relevance. This can strengthen insights.

Helpful Resources

The following are a few examples of resources (hyperlinked) that can help you prepare for your interview:

- [Introduction to Python Pandas](#)
- [Important Chart Components](#)
- [PowerPoint Tips](#)
- [Structure of PowerPoint Presentation](#)

Logistical Information + In-Person Tips

Logistical Information

First Round Interviews will take place March 2nd to 4th via Zoom.

Second round interviews will take place March 9th to 10th, room locations will be communicated via Calendly Invite.

If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact the Astra hiring team:

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In-Person Interview Tips

With the return of in-person interviews, there are a few things to remember:

Dress Code: During interviews, CREO recommends a business-casual dress code. This includes, but is not limited to, cardigans, dress shirts with no tie, knit sweaters, blouses, golf shirts, dockers, dress pants, slacks, and more.

Punctuality: To ensure the interview schedule runs relatively on time, it is important to remember to be punctual. In-person interviews will be held in a breakout room in Goodes Hall, and arriving early is recommended.

Professionalism: Unlike virtual interviews, in-person interviews require an additional element of professionalism. In addition to the two points above, it is important to present yourself well and follow basic interview etiquette and norms.

Enjoy It: Although easier said than done, try to enjoy the interview. Positive energy is contagious so try to smile and be enthusiastic throughout the interview.